

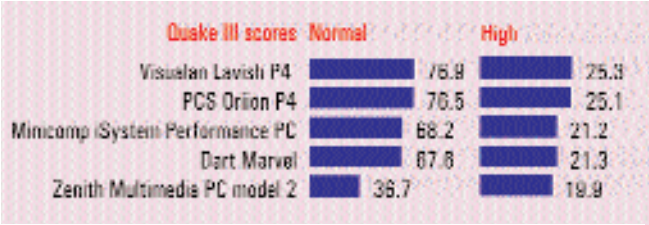
for test had a CD-ROM drive. Also, with integration of critical and sometimes expensive components such as sound and graphics cards as seen in the Intel 810 and 815-based motherboards, costs can be significantly lowered.

So if you need a low-cost PC for occasional gaming, small-time office usage, Internet surfing, and perhaps a few PC-intensive applications such as Adobe Photoshop, Corel Draw, 3D Max, etc, but would not need to work simultaneously with multiple applications (which means less stress on the processor), a PC with a Celeron/Duron-class processor with a clock speed ranging from 600 to 900 MHz with a standard 5,400-rpm 20-GB hard disk and integrated sound and multimedia should be suitable for your requirements.

In this category, a PC more for entertainment rather than work would be one like the **Nebula Qmax Triad**. With scores of 36.1 and 20 fps in *Quake III*, it is the highest in this category, but only by a slight margin. However, it will disappoint users looking for a lot of additional software and features as it comes loaded with just an operating system. Another point that went against this system was the average build

quality. However, in terms of overall scores, this computer did well. Another PC that gamers can consider is the Zenith PC, which incidentally was the only one in this category to bundle a P-III 1 GHz processor. It came in a close second in *Quake* with 35.8 and 19.9 fps, which means it will run most games in medium to low resolutions.

On the office productivity front, where users would like a good machine for applications and for others who keep a second PC at home for work, the **Nebula Qmax Triad** once again proved to be the best option available. It scored a fair index of 28.1, which was the highest in this category



The top five scorers in *Quake III* among the Midrange systems



ry in the ZDNet Content Creation test too. Coming in a close second is the Netracker P-III 933 MHz processor powered machine that posted a score of 27.9 in the Content Creation benchmark. Another factor that went in favour of this PC was that it had 128 MB of PC 133 MHz RAM allowing for greater leeway with memory-intensive applications. The difference was clearly visible as

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